



## 03 | How I Relate: Communication & Boundaries



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- I speak in systems, metaphors, and intentions. Literal words don’t always hold the whole truth.
- Silence = processing or protecting peace, not rejection.
- I prefer people who ask rather than assume.
- I’m not scared of conflict — but I am allergic to guilt trips and gaslighting.

### 3.1 When I Feel Safe

- I open up.
- I respond with more clarity.
- I offer deep emotional insight and loyalty.



Based on the selected section, here's how Cody's communication and relationship style is shaped by their intersecting identities:

**Communication Style:**

- They communicate through systems and metaphors rather than literal words, which is common in neurodivergent thinking patterns where pattern recognition and abstract connections are strengths.

**Processing Needs:**

- Their silence should be understood as either processing time or energy preservation, which is particularly important given their ADHD and PTSD needs for mental processing space.

**Boundaries and Trust:**

- They value direct questions over assumptions, which helps prevent misunderstandings that can be particularly challenging for neurodivergent individuals.
- While comfortable with conflict, they are sensitive to manipulation tactics like guilt trips and gaslighting, which can be particularly triggering for someone with PTSD.

**Safe Space Response:**

- When feeling safe, Cody becomes more open, communicates with greater clarity, and offers deep emotional insight and loyalty. This highlights the importance of creating safe, accepting environments, particularly important for someone navigating multiple marginalized identities.